

GLITTERBOLT

ROLLER CLUB

Lace up. Light up. Roll on.

Business Plan

Adult roller disco nights for Epsom and the Surrey borders

October 2026

Confidential

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1. Executive Summary

Glitterbolt Roller Club runs themed roller disco nights for adults. Each night has a DJ, coloured lighting, a 30 minute beginner lesson at the start and skate hire built into the ticket. The first nights run in a hired sports hall in Epsom, Surrey, once a month. Private hire for birthdays, hen parties and office socials runs alongside from the first summer, using the same kit.

The idea rests on a gap. Family roller discos already run across Surrey. Disco Skate holds monthly sessions at leisure centres in Woking, Guildford, Yateley and Aldershot, at £8 to £9 a head. Adult nights exist, but they sit in London (Roller Nation in Tottenham, Flipper's Roller Boogie Palace in west London) or further out (RollBack World runs an 18+ night in Bedford). In my searches I found no regular adult only roller night in Epsom, Sutton, Kingston or Leatherhead. That could mean nobody has tried. It could also mean somebody tried and could not make the numbers work. The pilot exists to find out which.

The numbers are modest, and the plan says so. In the base case revenue is £17,558 in Year 1 and £70,319 in Year 5. Year 1 makes a net loss of (£5,355) once pre-launch costs, rented pilot kit and depreciation are counted. Net profit is £808 in Year 2, £2,554 in Year 3 and £6,126 in Year 5. Cumulative profit turns positive in Year 4 (£1,669). This is a side business that could grow into a small business. It is not a plan to get rich.

Funding is £13,750 in total. That is £7,500 of the founder's cash, £750 from 25 pre-sold Founding Skater Passes, and a £5,500 Start Up Loan that is drawn only if the pilot passes its gate. The lowest cash balance in Year 1 is £735, so the plan survives, but only just. Stopping after the three pilot nights would cost roughly £5,008. Committing to the fleet and loan up front would put about £11,158 at risk. That difference is the reason for the pilot.

The biggest risk. The hall. The plan assumes £50 an hour. The only published local rate I found is Bourne Hall in Epsom at £115 an hour on weekday evenings and £160 at weekends (community rate, 2026/27). At £115 the business loses £2,451 in Year 3 before the founder is paid. Nothing else in the model moves the result as far.

Key figure	Value
Average ticket yield after discounts	£13.82
Contribution per skater before night costs	£15.19
Cost of one night on owned kit	£645.00
Break-even attendance (owned kit)	43 skaters (54% of an 80 skater hall)
Pilot night cost on rented kit	£1,212.50
Pre-launch costs	£2,343
Skate fleet, pads and helmets (Year 1)	£6,150
Event nights, Year 1 and Year 5	16 and 40
Pilot decision gate	End of April 2027, after three nights

2. Mission and Vision

The mission is simple. Get adults out of their seats on a Friday night and back on wheels, with music loud enough to dance to and a floor friendly enough that a beginner does not feel foolish.

Fun is the product here, so the plan treats it seriously. A night that feels flat will not be rebooked, and everything else in the model depends on people coming back. That is why the first half hour of every night is a lesson, why the themes change every month, and why marshals are paid to look after the nervous skaters first.

The vision has three steps. In Year 1 it is a pilot, three nights proving that people in Epsom will pay to skate. By Year 3 it is two nights a month in the same hall or a second one, with private hire as a steady second income. By Year 5 it is around 40 nights a year, run by a small casual team, with the founder paid something for the time. No step is committed to until the one before has earned it.

3. The Concept

A Glitterbolt night is a club night where everyone is on wheels. The hall is dressed with lights and a mirror ball. The DJ plays to the theme. Skates, wrist guards, elbow pads and knee pads come with the ticket, and helmets are free to anyone who asks. Over 18s only.

What happens on a night

Time	What happens
6.30pm	Hall opens to the team. Floor checked and cleaned, lights up, kit laid out by size.
7.30pm	Doors. Skate fitting at the kit table. Pads on. Music starts at low volume.
8.00pm	First Wheels lesson. Thirty minutes for beginners with two marshals. Regulars warm up on the other half of the floor.
8.30pm	Open skate with the DJ. Marshals on the floor throughout.
9.30pm	Theme moment. A limbo, a spotlight skate or a fancy dress parade, depending on the night.
10.45pm	Last song. Skates back to the kit table.
11.00pm	Lights up. Pack down by 11.30pm.

That is five hours of hall hire for a three and a half hour session. The model uses all five hours, because setup and pack down are not free.

The themes

Each month has a theme, and the theme sets the music, the dress code and the content for social media. The first year runs Soul and Funk, Neon 80s, Y2K Pop, a summer Disco Classics night, Halloween Ghoul Skate in October, 90s Rewind and a Glitter Ball Christmas. Themes matter for a practical reason. A regular who has been three times needs a new reason to come a fourth time, and a theme gives them one.

Honest limits

This is not a rink. A hired sports hall has a hard floor, a fixed size and a caretaker with opinions. The floor may be less grippy or less smooth than a purpose built rink, and some halls will not allow wheels at all. Roller Nation in Tottenham is a proper venue with a bar and a diner, and Glitterbolt cannot match that. What it can do is arrive in Epsom, which matters to anyone who would otherwise take a late train home from London.

4. The Problem and the Gap

An adult in Epsom who wants a roller disco has two choices today. They can go to a family session at a leisure centre, where the skaters are eight years old and the music is chosen for them. Or they can travel into London for an adult night, which is a longer evening and a more expensive one.

The family sessions are good at what they do. Disco Skate runs monthly sessions across Surrey and Hampshire, includes skate and wrist guard hire in the ticket, and keeps the price low at £8 to £9. I do not think Glitterbolt should try to beat that. A beginner adult at a family session is usually there as a parent, and they are not the customer I am after.

There is a fair argument against all of this. Adults in Epsom may simply not want it. A pub quiz is cheaper, a bar is easier and nobody falls over at either. The pandemic roller boom is described by skate retailers and operators as a lasting comeback, but those are people who sell skates, and I would not treat their blogs as independent evidence. I think the gap is real because Roller Nation prices its Halloween night at £20 and the family sessions in Surrey keep adding venues. I could be wrong. That is why the plan spends £2,343 and three nights finding out before it spends anything large.

5. Market Opportunity

I have not used a top down market size here. Figures like "the global roller skating market will reach X billion" come from report sellers with little method behind them, and they say nothing about whether 55 people will turn up at a hall in Epsom on a Friday. The sizing in this plan is built from the bottom.

Each night needs about 55 paid skaters to cover its costs and leave something over. The break-even point is 43 skaters on owned kit. The question is whether Epsom, Ewell, Leatherhead, Sutton, Cheam, Kingston and the villages between can supply 55 adults who will pay £15 once a month. That is a small ask of a catchment that large. It is a bigger ask of the part of it that is willing to try roller skating.

Signs of demand

Four signals point the same way. Disco Skate lists two new venues in 2026 (Yateley and Aldershot). Kent Roller Disco has run sessions since 2005 and now covers around ten Kent towns at £7.50 to £9. RollBack World runs 18+ nights in Bedford from 8pm to 1am. Roller Nation prices Halloween 2026 at £20 (£15 flash sale). One signal points the other way. RollBack World's family sessions at Leatherhead Leisure Centre, the closest to Epsom, are listed as postponed. I do not know why, and I would ask them.

Who the customers are

Segment	Who they are	How to reach them	Priority
Social groups, 25 to 40	Friends looking for something to do that is not a pub. Book as a group of four to eight.	Instagram, TikTok, local Facebook groups, word of mouth.	High
Birthday and hen groups	Organisers who want a private slot and will pay more for it.	Private hire page, Google search, venue recommendations.	High
Young adults, 18 to 24	Students and early career. Price sensitive, sociable, shareable.	University for the Creative Arts in Epsom, student societies, short video.	Medium
Couples and date nights	Looking for a night out that is not dinner.	Valentine themed night, Instagram.	Medium
Nostalgia crowd, 40 plus	Skated as teenagers in the 80s and 90s. Likely to hire skates and stay close to the wall.	Neon 80s and 90s Rewind nights, local press, Facebook.	Medium

6. Competition

Business plans use real competitor names because the founder needs real facts. Everything below comes from each operator's public pages in October 2026. Prices change, so each one should be rechecked before launch.

Operator	Where	Format and price	What it leaves open
Disco Skate	Woking, Guildford, Yateley, Fleet, Aldershot	Monthly family roller discos at leisure centres. £8 to £9 with skates and wrist guards included, £1 off with own skates. Also parties, lessons and repairs.	Family timing, with sessions ending by 9.30pm at the latest. No adult only nights found.
Leatherhead Roller Disco (RollBack World)	Leatherhead Leisure Centre, Fetcham	Family sessions, £6 entry plus £1 skate hire, 90 minutes. Listed as postponed.	The closest operator to Epsom, and it has paused. That is a warning and an opening.
RollBack World adult nights	Bedford	18+ nights, 8pm to 1am, £10 at first release, skate hire if needed, DJs and marshals.	Proves the adult format works. Too far from Surrey.
Roller Nation	Tottenham, north London	Purpose built roller disco with a diner and bar. Club nights and family sessions. Halloween 2026 is £20 (£15 flash sale).	A better venue than any hall, but across London from Epsom.
Flipper's Roller Boogie Palace	Ariel Way, west London	Event prices listed at £12.50 to £17.50, skate hire £5.	Central London travel and pricing.
Kent Roller Disco	Around ten Kent towns	Running since 2005. £7.50 to £9 including skate hire.	Shows a multi hall monthly model can last twenty years. It is family led and in Kent.
Superfunk Roller Disco	Mobile, UK wide	14 years in business. Bespoke quotes for DJ, PA, lighting and coaches. Schools, festivals, corporate clients.	Competes for private hire, and offers consulting to venues that want their own night.
Sk8hire and Sk8house	Warwickshire, mobile	Company registered 2016. Mobile rinks with flooring, DJs and lighting. Up to £10 million public liability cover.	Competes for corporate hire.
Roller Kings	Newbury, Berkshire	Sells and hires kit. A package for 80 skaters is £20,995. Hire from £460 for 41 to 50 pairs.	A supplier first. It also sells the means to start a rival.

How the market works

Rivalry is low in Epsom itself and moderate in the wider area. The barriers to entry are also low. Roller Kings sells a start up package, Superfunk consults for new operators, and a first time organiser can begin with hired kit and a village hall. That cuts both ways. It means Glitterbolt can start for little. It also means someone else can.

Two parties hold most of the power, and neither is the customer. Hall owners set the biggest cost line. Kit suppliers set the price of the fleet. Customers have almost no switching costs, because another night out is always an option. Substitutes are everywhere, from bowling to bars to escape rooms, so the product has to feel like an event and not like a place to stand.

The moat, if there is one, is small. It is a brand people recognise, a calendar they plan around, and a relationship with a hall that is hard to replace. None of that exists on day one. It has to be built, one night at a time.

7. Business Model and Pricing

There are three income streams. Tickets are the engine. Drinks, snacks and glitter bar sales add a smaller layer. Private hire adds a separate income that does not depend on how many people turn up on a given Friday.

Ticket prices

Ticket	Price	Notes
Advance, skate hire included	£15	Skates, wrist guards, elbow pads and knee pads. Helmets free on request.
Advance, own skates	£12	Own skates must pass a quick check at the door.
Door	£2 more	Not modelled. Leaving it out makes the plan slightly cautious.
Founding Skater Pass	£30	Three pilot nights for £30. Twenty five sold before launch is the first demand test.

The model works with an average yield of £13.82 a skater after discounts and concessions. It assumes 85 percent of skaters hire and 15 percent bring their own. After ticketing fees and the margin on drinks and snacks, each skater adds £15.19 before any night costs.

Is £15 right? It sits above the £10 Bedford price and below Roller Nation's £20 Halloween price. Flipper's is listed at £12.50 to £17.50, and Disco Skate's family night is £8 to £9. I think £15 is defensible for a themed adult night with a lesson, and I would rather start there and discount than start low and try to raise it. The sensitivity table shows what each £2 is worth. It is worth about £3,600 a year in Year 3.

Where the money comes from

Stream	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Net ticket revenue	£12,002	£20,502	£28,155	£35,888	£42,316
Drinks, snacks and glitter bar	£3,556	£5,933	£8,148	£10,385	£12,246
Private hire	£2,000	£5,150	£8,487	£12,020	£15,757
Total revenue	£17,558	£31,584	£44,790	£58,293	£70,319
Share from tickets	68%	65%	63%	62%	60%

Private hire

A private event is two hours for up to 40 skaters at £500, with kit, DJ and marshals included. Direct costs are £190, which leaves £310 a booking, a margin of 62%. In Year 3 a private event earns about £329 against £268 for a public night. That is a fair argument for leaning harder on private hire than the plan does. I held back for two reasons. The £500 price is an assumption, because competitors quote by enquiry only. And the public nights are what make people aware the business exists.

A licensed bar, later

The base case sells no alcohol. A licensed bar is the obvious upgrade, and the sensitivity table shows it adding about £3,361 to Year 3 profit if spend rises to £7 a head. It also brings a Temporary Event Notice for each night, closer supervision of drinking and skating, and a conversation with the insurer. I would revisit it in Year 2, once the nights run smoothly without it.

8. Venue Strategy

Everything else in this plan depends on one number, the hourly cost of a hall. The model assumes £50. That is an assumption and not a quote. The only published rate I found near Epsom is Bourne Hall, which charges £115 an hour for the main hall on weekday evenings and £160 on weekends at the community rate for 2026/27. The standard rates are £118 and £180.

At those prices the plan does not work. A Friday night at Bourne Hall would cost £575 for five hours, against £250 in the model. A Saturday would cost £800. I checked the council's own fee schedule for those figures. I did not check whether the floor suits skates, and that is a second question to ask before anything else.

Venue type	Likely cost	Strengths	Watch for
Council hall (Bourne Hall)	£115 weekday evening, £160 weekend (verified, community rate)	Central, known, well lit.	Cost. Floor type unknown. Will they allow wheels.
Leisure centre sports hall	To be quoted	Sprung wooden floor, changing rooms, parking, staff on site.	Booking windows, fixed closing times, the centre may want its own bar sales.
School sports hall	To be quoted	Often cheaper in evenings and holidays.	Term time rules, caretaker hours, insurance conditions.
Community or church hall	To be quoted	Cheapest.	Floors are often wrong for wheels. Capacity limits.
Private function venue	To be quoted	Atmosphere already built.	Bar minimum spends, higher hire fee.

The Skate Sanctuary, an operator that publishes advice for new roller disco organisers, suggests a council run sports hall that will add the session to its own timetable and take the payments. That is worth asking for. It also advises checking the cancellation policy, because most halls will not let a night be cancelled at the last minute if nobody buys tickets, and the organiser pays regardless.

Decision rule. Do not sign for a hall above £75 an hour unless the deal includes a share of door income instead of a flat fee, or the ticket price can rise to £17. At £75 an hour Year 3 profit before founder pay falls to £3,915. At £115 it is (£2,451).

9. Operations Plan

Kit

The first three nights run on hired kit. Roller Kings hires 41 to 50 pairs of skates for 72 hours at £460, plus pad sets at £2.20 each and helmets at £3.25 each. A £250 deposit is refundable and not counted in the model. The total for a pilot night is £602.50, which makes each pilot night loss making by design. Three nights of hire cost £1,808. Buying the fleet at that stage would cost £6,150. If the pilot fails, the difference stays in the bank.

If the gate passes, the fleet is bought in May 2027. The model buys 50 pairs at £110 plus £10 of pads per pair, and £150 of helmets and cases. The £110 is an assumption. The Roller Kings package of 145 pairs, 80 pad sets, 10 helmets and five cases costs £20,995, about £145 a pair all in, so £110 relies on buying in bulk or refurbished. I need quotes. A further 20 pairs are added in Year 2 and 10 in Year 4, which takes the fleet to 80.

The floor team

In Year 1 the founder works as a marshal, with two paid marshals and a DJ. From Year 2 there are three paid marshals. One person on the floor for every 20 skaters is the target in the first half hour, when most falls happen. One marshal or the founder holds a first aid certificate on every night. An incident book records every fall that needs more than a plaster.

Booking and entry

Tickets sell through a booking page, which also collects the waiver and an email address. Age is checked at the door. The ticketing fee in the model is 6 percent of ticket revenue, which is an assumption and depends on the platform. Capacity is capped at 80 skaters, so the pilot can sell out, which is useful for marketing.

Transport and storage

Kit moves in a hired van or a car and trailer, at £40 a night. It is stored in a rented garage share at £360 a year. If family space is available, that line drops to zero.

Year 1 at a glance

Month	Nights	Skaters a night	What is happening
Nov 2026 to Jan 2027	0	None	Pre-launch. Insurance, licence, hall, Founding Skater Pass sales, kit hire booked.
Feb 2027	1	40	Pilot night 1. Rented kit.
Mar 2027	1	48	Pilot night 2. Rented kit.
Apr 2027	1	55	Pilot night 3. Gate decision at the end of the month.
May 2027	1	52	Fleet bought and loan drawn, if the gate returns GO.
Jun to Sep 2027	1 a month	55, 55, 50, 50	Monthly nights. First private hire events from July.
Oct 2027	2	60	Halloween Ghou! Skate. Second night each month begins.
Nov 2027	2	62	Neon 80s.
Dec 2027	2	68	Glitter Ball Christmas.
Jan 2028	2	52	Quieter month. Review of Year 1.

10. Marketing and Brand

The brand is playful, glittery and inclusive. It uses deep purple, hot magenta, sunshine yellow and teal, and it should look like a night out and not like a sports club. The tone is warm and a bit silly. Nobody should feel they need to be good at skating to belong.

Founding Skater Pass

Before a hall is signed, the plan sells 25 passes at £30 each. A pass covers the three pilot nights. The £750 raised funds early costs, but the real value is the test. If 25 strangers will pay £30 for a night that does not exist yet, the idea has legs. If the founder cannot sell 25 to friends and friends of friends, it is better to learn that before paying a hall.

Content that people share

The strongest content is a beginner learning to skate. A short video of a nervous first timer at 8.00pm and a confident one at 10.30pm is the sort of thing people send to a friend. The plan posts three or four short videos a week, with clips from each night. Marketing spend in Year 1 is £1,200, about £1.35 for every skater visit.

Local routes

Local Facebook groups for Epsom, Ewell, Leatherhead and Sutton are the cheapest route. The University for the Creative Arts has a campus in Epsom and is worth a conversation with its students' union. Dance studios, gyms and hen party planners are natural partners, and each could send groups of four to eight. A referral price (bring a friend and both pay £13) fits inside the 5 percent discount allowance.

First year themes

Month	Theme	Music and dress
Feb 2027	Soul and Funk Friday	Motown, funk and soul. Wear what you like.
Mar 2027	Neon 80s	Synths and pop. Neon, legwarmers, headbands.
Apr 2027	Y2K Pop	Early 2000s pop and R&B. Butterfly clips, denim.
May and Jun 2027	Disco Classics	Seventies disco. Sequins welcome.
Jul and Aug 2027	Summer Glow	Light up gear, glow sticks.
Sep 2027	90s Rewind	Dance, Britpop, hip hop.
Oct 2027	Halloween Ghouls Skate	Fancy dress with a prize. Two nights.
Nov 2027	Neon 80s, the sequel	A repeat of the best seller.
Dec 2027	Glitter Ball Christmas	Festive disco. Two nights.

11. Management and Organisation

In Year 1 the founder does almost everything. That means booking the hall, buying the kit, running the social media, managing the door and working the floor as a marshal. Two paid marshals and a DJ are casual workers hired night by night.

I estimate each night costs about 12 hours of the founder's time once setup, the night, pack down and admin are added. Sixteen nights in Year 1 is about 190 hours, before pre-launch work. Founder pay is zero in Years 1 and 2 and rises to £9,000 in Year 5. By then the work is about 1,000 hours a year including private events and admin. That is under £9 an hour. It is not a wage. It becomes one only if the business grows beyond one person's evenings, and this plan does not pretend otherwise.

Role	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3 to 5
Founder, host and marshal	Full time on event nights	Same	Same, with a lead marshal taking floor duties
Paid marshals	2 a night	3 a night	3 a night
DJ	Local DJ, £100 a night	Same	Resident DJ
Bookkeeper	Outsourced, £420 a year	Same	Same
Second hall lead	None	None	Year 5, if a second hall is open

Skills gaps

Three gaps are obvious. Skating instruction, first aid and accounting. The first is covered by working with a local coach or skate club for the First Wheels lesson. The second is covered by a one day emergency first aid course for two people, budgeted at £300. The third is covered by a bookkeeper at £420 a year. There is no advisory board, but the plan includes asking an experienced operator for an hour of advice. Several, including Superfunk, openly consult for new entrants.

12. Financial Projections

All figures below come from the Excel model, Glitterbolt Roller Club Financial Model.xlsx, and match it to the pound. The model uses formulas throughout, so a changed assumption flows through every table. All figures are modelled estimates and should be read as directional.

Revenue

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Event nights	16	24	30	36	40
Average skaters a night	55.6	60.0	64.0	66.0	68.0
Total skater visits	889	1,440	1,920	2,376	2,720
Share of an 80 skater hall	69%	75%	80%	83%	85%
Net ticket revenue	£12,002	£20,502	£28,155	£35,888	£42,316
Drinks, snacks and glitter bar	£3,556	£5,933	£8,148	£10,385	£12,246
Private hire events	4	10	16	22	28
Private hire revenue	£2,000	£5,150	£8,487	£12,020	£15,757
Total revenue	£17,558	£31,584	£44,790	£58,293	£70,319

Attendance rises from an average of 55.6 skaters in Year 1 to 68 in Year 5, which is 85% of the hall. That is a cautious ceiling, since a hall of 80 does not need to fill every night. It is also the number I would test hardest. A new night that fills 85 percent of the hall every time would be a very good night.

Costs

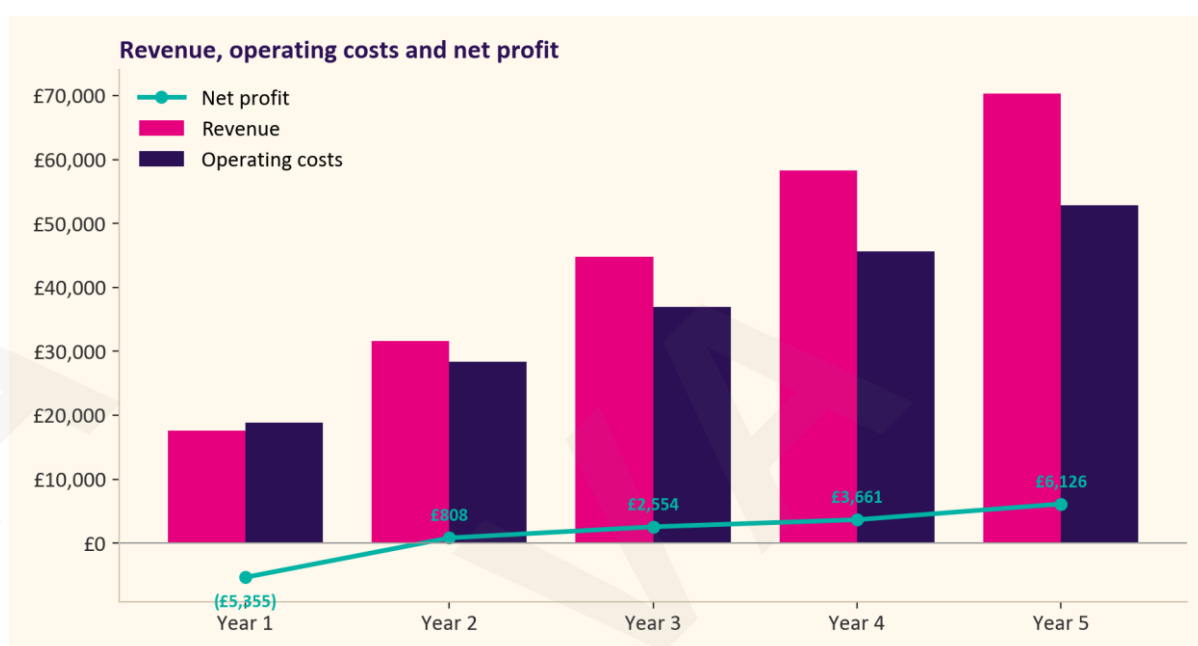
	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Hall hire	£4,000	£6,180	£7,957	£9,835	£11,255
DJ	£1,600	£2,472	£3,183	£3,934	£4,502
Paid marshals	£2,400	£5,562	£7,161	£8,851	£10,130
Music licence	£720	£1,112	£1,432	£1,770	£2,026
Transport	£640	£989	£1,273	£1,574	£1,801
Cleaning and first aid restock	£400	£618	£796	£983	£1,126
Wear on owned kit	£455	£865	£1,114	£1,377	£1,576
Pilot kit hire	£1,808	£0	£0	£0	£0
Cost of drinks and snacks	£1,600	£2,670	£3,666	£4,673	£5,510
Ticketing and card fees	£720	£1,230	£1,689	£2,153	£2,539
Private hire direct costs	£760	£1,957	£3,225	£4,568	£5,988
Total direct costs	£15,103	£23,655	£31,496	£39,718	£46,452
Insurance	£1,200	£1,236	£1,273	£1,311	£1,351
Accounting	£420	£433	£446	£459	£473
Website and software	£240	£247	£255	£262	£270
Kit storage	£360	£371	£382	£393	£405

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Kit maintenance	£300	£433	£446	£525	£540
Marketing	£1,200	£2,000	£2,600	£3,000	£3,300
Total overheads	£3,720	£4,719	£5,401	£5,950	£6,339
Total operating costs	£18,823	£28,374	£36,897	£45,668	£52,791

Profit and loss

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Total revenue	£17,558	£31,584	£44,790	£58,293	£70,319
Direct costs	£15,103	£23,655	£31,496	£39,718	£46,452
Gross profit	£2,455	£7,929	£13,294	£18,575	£23,867
Gross margin	14%	25%	30%	32%	34%
Overheads	£3,720	£4,719	£5,401	£5,950	£6,339
Pre-launch costs	£2,343	£0	£0	£0	£0
Operating profit before depreciation, interest and founder pay	(£3,608)	£3,210	£7,893	£12,625	£17,528
Depreciation of skate fleet	£1,538	£2,138	£2,138	£2,438	£900
Loan interest	£209	£264	£202	£135	£65
Founder pay	£0	£0	£3,000	£6,000	£9,000
Profit before tax	(£5,355)	£808	£2,554	£4,052	£7,563
Estimated tax	£0	£0	£0	£391	£1,437
Net profit	(£5,355)	£808	£2,554	£3,661	£6,126
Cumulative net profit	(£5,355)	(£4,546)	(£1,992)	£1,669	£7,795

Tax is a flat 19 percent stand-in with losses carried forward. A sole trader would pay income tax instead. Treat the tax line as an indication.

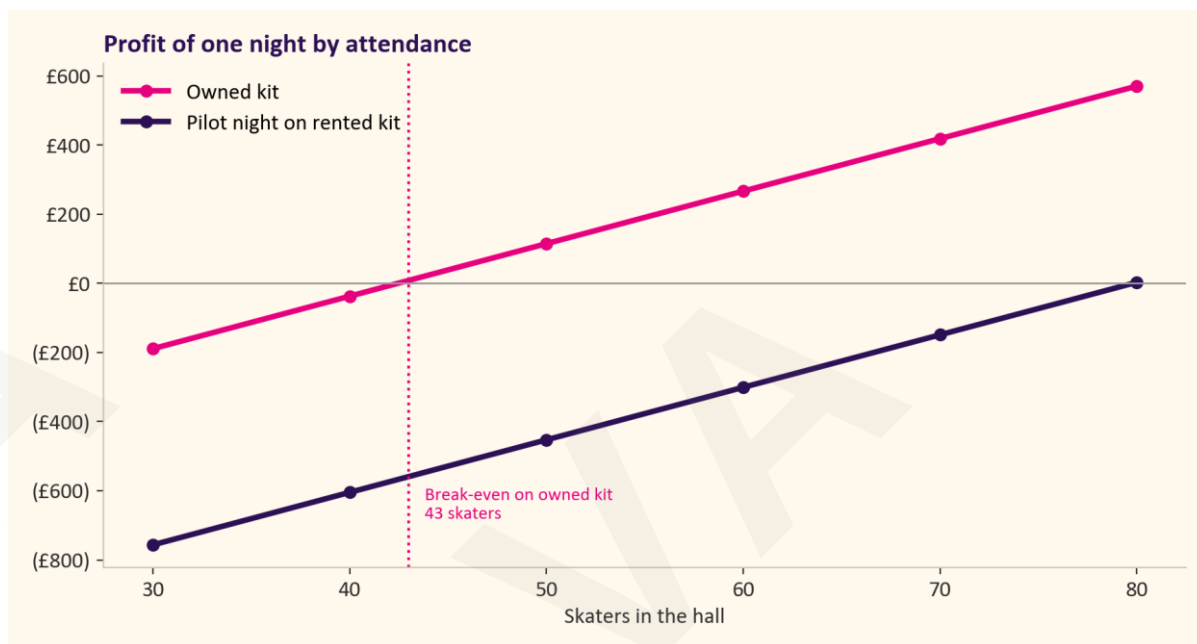


Revenue, operating costs and net profit, Years 1 to 5. Source, the Financial Model.

Gross margin is 14% in Year 1 and 34% in Year 5. It starts thin because three pilot nights carry £1,808 of kit hire, and it improves as nights fill and private hire grows. A low gross margin is normal for a business with a hall and a team to pay every time the doors open. The overheads are small, £3,720 in Year 1, and that is what lets the business reach break-even without a large crowd.

Unit economics

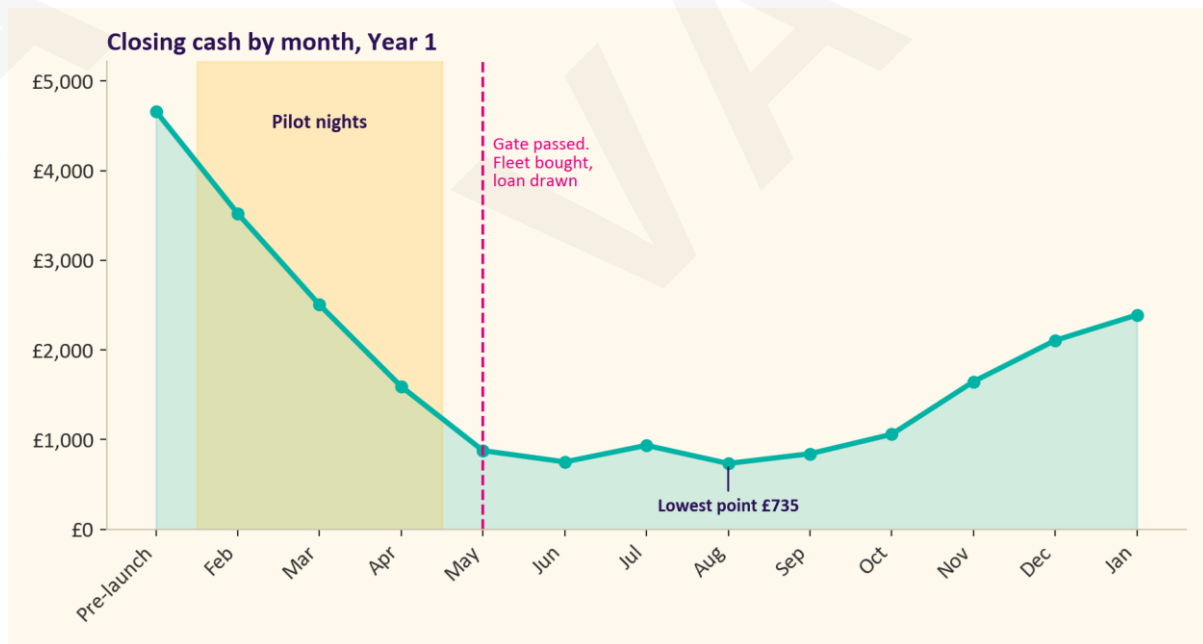
One night on owned kit costs £645.00, made up of the hall (£250), DJ (£100), marshals (£150), music licence (£45), transport (£40), cleaning (£25) and kit wear (£35). Each skater contributes £15.19. The night breaks even at 43 skaters. A pilot night on rented kit costs £1,212.50 and would need the hall to be full. It is not meant to make money.



Profit of one night at different attendance levels, owned kit against rented pilot kit.

Cash and funding

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Opening cash	£0	£2,391	£1,925	£5,542	£9,691
Receipts from customers	£17,558	£31,584	£44,790	£58,293	£70,319
Operating costs paid	(£18,823)	(£28,374)	(£36,897)	(£45,668)	(£52,791)
Pre-launch costs	(£2,343)	£0	£0	£0	£0
Founder pay	£0	£0	(£3,000)	(£6,000)	(£9,000)
Tax paid	£0	£0	£0	£0	(£391)
Skate fleet, pads and helmets	(£6,150)	(£2,400)	£0	(£1,200)	£0
Founder cash in	£7,500	£0	£0	£0	£0
Start Up Loan drawn	£5,500	£0	£0	£0	£0
Start Up Loan repayments	(£851)	(£1,276)	(£1,276)	(£1,276)	(£1,276)
Net cash flow	£2,391	(£466)	£3,617	£4,149	£6,861
Closing cash	£2,391	£1,925	£5,542	£9,691	£16,552



Closing cash by month in Year 1. The pilot nights, the gate and the lowest point are marked.

Cash falls in the pilot, because rented kit and early costs are paid before nights earn much. It reaches its lowest point of £735 in August 2027, after the fleet is bought and loan repayments begin. Autumn nights lift it. That is a thin margin of safety. Each skater short of plan costs about £15.19, so three nights that each run 20 skaters short would use up the whole cushion. The answer is not to pretend the risk is small. It is to hold back the loan until the gate has passed and to keep a small reserve from the founder's own money.

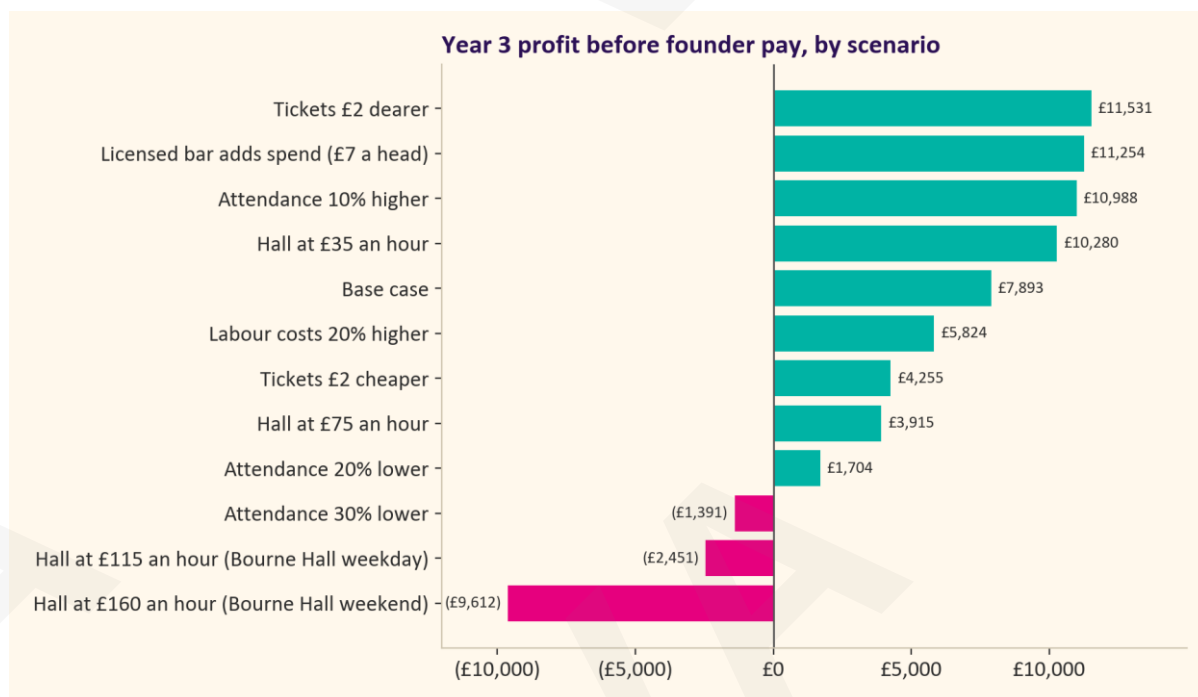
Sources	Amount	Uses (fixed)	Amount
Founder cash	£7,500	Pre-launch costs	£2,343
Founding Skater Passes (25)	£750	First year insurance	£1,200
Start Up Loan (after the gate)	£5,500	Pilot kit hire	£1,808
		Skate fleet, pads and helmets	£6,150
Total sources	£13,750	Total fixed uses	£11,501

That leaves £2,250 to cover nights, overheads and loan repayments until ticket income takes over. The loan runs over five years at 6 percent, an assumption to be checked against the scheme's current terms. Repayments are £106.33 a month.

13. Scenarios and Sensitivity

Year 3 is the first year the business should be running as intended, so it is the year used for testing. Each row below changes one thing and leaves everything else at the base case. The result shown is profit before founder pay, depreciation and interest, then profit before tax.

Scenario	Skaters a night	Cost of a night	Profit a night	Break-even skaters	Year 3 profit before founder pay	Year 3 profit before tax
Base case	64.0	£764	£268	48	£7,893	£2,554
Attendance 20% lower	51.2	£764	£61	48	£1,704	(£3,635)
Attendance 30% lower	44.8	£764	(£42)	48	(£1,391)	(£6,730)
Attendance 10% higher	70.4	£764	£371	48	£10,988	£5,649
Hall at £35 an hour	64.0	£684	£347	43	£10,280	£4,941
Hall at £75 an hour	64.0	£896	£135	56	£3,915	(£1,424)
Hall at £115 an hour (Bourne Hall weekday evening)	64.0	£1,109	(£77)	69	(£2,451)	(£7,790)
Hall at £160 an hour (Bourne Hall weekend evening)	64.0	£1,347	(£316)	84	(£9,612)	(£14,951)
Tickets £2 cheaper	64.0	£764	£146	54	£4,255	(£1,084)
Tickets £2 dearer	64.0	£764	£389	43	£11,531	£6,192
Labour costs 20% higher	64.0	£833	£199	52	£5,824	£485
Licensed bar adds spend (£7 a head)	64.0	£764	£380	43	£11,254	£5,915



Year 3 profit before founder pay under each scenario.

Four ways to read it

Base case. Modest and survivable. Cumulative profit turns positive in Year 4.

Optimistic. Any one of three things adds about £3,000 to £3,600 a year in Year 3. Attendance 10 percent higher adds £3,095. Tickets £2 dearer adds £3,638. A licensed bar adds £3,361. None of these needs a miracle, and they stack.

Pessimistic. Attendance 20 percent lower leaves £1,704 before founder pay, which is thin. Attendance 30 percent lower is a loss of £1,391. A bad hall and bad attendance together would hurt far more, and the table does not model that pairing. It should be tested before any hall is signed.

Contrarian. Private hire earns about £329 an event in Year 3 against £268 for a public night, and it carries no ticket risk. A sceptic would say run private hire only and skip the nights. That is a fair view. The reply is that private hire needs somewhere to be seen, and the public nights are the shop window. I would still test it. If the pilot is weak and private hire enquiries are strong, the plan should change shape and not simply stop.

14. Risk Analysis

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	What the plan does about it
Hall costs more than assumed	High	High	Get written quotes from five halls before any commitment. Apply the £75 an hour decision rule. Ask for a share of door income.
Pilot attendance below break-even	Medium	High	Pilot gate with GO, EXTEND and STOP outcomes. Loan only drawn after GO. Cost of stopping is about £5,008.
Serious injury and a claim	Medium	High	Public liability cover of £5 million or more, pads included in every ticket, marshals, first aider on every night, waiver, incident book.
Founder is the single point of failure	High	High	A trained second marshal who can run a night. Written run sheet. Never run two nights in a week in Year 1.
Adult roller fades as a trend	Medium	Medium	Private hire as a second income. Themes change monthly. Kit can be resold.
A competitor copies the idea	Medium	Medium	Move first and build a loyal following. Lock in hall relationships. Keep the brand playful and local.
Insurance or music licence cost more than assumed	Medium	Medium	Quotes before launch. Both lines are in the sensitivity table.
Skate theft, loss or damage	Low	Medium	Kit count at start and end of each night. Damage deposit in the ticket terms. Insured kit.
Noise complaints or hall conflict	Low	Medium	Choose halls away from homes. Agree finishing time in the contract. Keep to it.

The wider picture

A quick PESTLE check. Politically, councils are the main hall owners and their fee schedules rise yearly (the Bourne Hall community rate for weekday evenings rose 8.5 percent for 2026/27). Economically, people have less to spend on nights out, and a £15 ticket is easy to cut. Socially, interest in retro culture and shared experiences helps. Technologically, short video is the marketing engine. Legally, insurance and safety rules apply, covered in the next section. Environmentally, the plan uses a car and trailer, and kit that lasts years.

If the gate says STOP, the plan is simple. Do not draw the loan. Return the rented kit. Sell the speaker and lights. Honour any Founding Skater Passes with a refund. The cost is the pre-launch spend, the pilot kit hire and the lost evenings.

15. Legal and Regulatory Framework

This section is a working checklist, not legal advice. Each item needs checking against the current rules before launch. I have noted the ones I could not confirm.

Insurance

Public liability cover is not a legal requirement for a roller disco, but no hall will let the organiser in without it. Halls and councils commonly ask for £5 million. Established operators carry £10 million, and Sk8hire quotes up to £10 million. Specialist roller disco policies exist, and roller skating carries a higher premium than most sports because insurers judge the injury risk to be higher. The model uses £1,200 a year, which is an assumption. If the business employs anyone, even casually, employers' liability insurance is a legal requirement, with a minimum cover of £5 million, and £10 million is the usual policy limit.

Music licensing

Playing recorded music at a disco needs a licence from PPL PRS, known as TheMusicLicence. A club night or disco falls under a Specially Featured Entertainment tariff, which PPL revised from 1 January 2026. The page does not publish a price. The hall may already hold a licence that covers some use, so the first step is to ask. The model puts £45 a night as a placeholder. A quote is needed.

Alcohol

The base case sells none. If it did, the options are a Temporary Event Notice for each night (£21 each, with annual limits per person and per premises) or a hall that already holds a premises licence and agrees to run the bar. Check the current limits on gov.uk before committing. Alcohol also requires age checks, and mixing it with skating adds a risk the insurer will ask about.

Health and safety

The Health and Safety at Work Act and the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations require a written risk assessment for the activity. It should cover falls, floor condition, crowd flow, kit checks, first aid, emergency exits and the first half hour of each night. The hall's own fire risk assessment and capacity limits apply too. At least one qualified first aider should be on site on every night. There is no specific roller disco law in the UK, so the insurer's conditions and good practice from other operators are the practical standard.

Employment

Casual marshals are workers and are entitled to at least the National Living Wage, holiday pay and a written statement of terms. The model's £15 an hour allows for that and for employer costs. The rate should be rechecked before hiring. A payroll set up is needed once anyone is paid, and the bookkeeper in the model covers it.

Data protection and consumer law

Names, emails and signed waivers are personal data, so UK GDPR applies. The business needs a short privacy notice, secure storage, and to check whether an annual fee to the Information Commissioner's Office applies. Ticket terms need to be clear on refunds, age limits and what happens if a night is cancelled. The waiver does not remove the organiser's legal duty of care, and the plan should not rely on it as if it does.

Food and drink

Selling pre-packed snacks and soft drinks is low risk, but anyone selling food must register with the local authority at least 28 days before trading. Check the rule for the first hall's borough.

Accessibility, age and the business structure

The Equality Act 2010 requires reasonable adjustments for disabled customers, so the plan notes the hall's access and offers a seated area and a helper skater where it can. Nights are strictly 18 and over, with age checked at the door. This also avoids the safeguarding duties that come with under 18s. The business starts as a sole trader, which is the cheapest and quickest option. Once it is profitable and carrying real kit, a limited company becomes sensible, probably in Year 2 or 3, mainly to separate personal and business liability.

16. Implementation Timeline

The weekly detail sits in the separate Action Plan. This is the outline.

Phase	When	What happens	Gate
Pre-launch	Nov 2026 to Jan 2027	Ring five halls. Price insurance, licence and kit. Build the booking page and brand. Sell 25 Founding Skater Passes. Book pilot kit hire.	Gate 1. 25 passes sold and a hall under £75 an hour. If not, stop or rethink.
Pilot	Feb to Apr 2027	Three monthly nights on rented kit. Track attendance, advance sales and repeat intent.	Gate 2. Average attendance 45 or more, 60 percent advance sales, 70 percent would return.
Growth	May 2027 to Jan 2028	Buy fleet. Draw loan. Monthly then twice monthly nights. First private events.	Gate 3. Cash above zero and 50 skaters a night by October.
Year 2	Feb 2028 to Jan 2029	About 24 nights and 10 private events. Review a licensed bar. Add 20 pairs.	Gate 4. Net profit positive.
Years 3 to 5	Feb 2029 onwards	Up to 40 nights a year, a second hall in Year 5, limited company in place.	Annual review.

The plan has a right to stop at every gate. A stop is not a failure. It is the plan doing its job.

Appendix A. Sources and Evidence

Facts about competitors come from their public websites in October 2026. They are listed as domain names. Rates and prices change often, and everything marked as a figure in this plan should be rechecked before a decision is taken.

Source	Used for
discoskate.co.uk	Disco Skate session locations, October 2026 dates, prices of £8 to £9, skates and wrist guards included, parties and lessons.
rollbackworld.com	Leatherhead family session details (postponed) and the Bedford 18+ night at £10, 8pm to 1am.
rollernation.com and rollerdisco.com	Roller Nation format, diner and bar, Halloween 2026 pricing of £20 (£15 flash sale).
kentrollerdisco.co.uk	Running since 2005, towns served, £7.50 to £9 including skate hire.
superfunkrollerdisco.com	Mobile operator, 14 years, bespoke pricing, venue consulting.
sk8hire.co.uk	Mobile rinks, company registered 2016, up to £10 million public liability.
rollerkings.co.uk	Skate hire tiers (41 to 50 pairs £460 plus £250 deposit, pads £2.20, helmets £3.25), 145 pair package at £20,995, lights and speaker hire.
theskatesanctuary.co.uk	Advice for new organisers on monthly sessions, council halls and cancellation policy.
democracy.epsom-ewell.gov.uk (fees and charges 2026/27)	Bourne Hall hire rates, £115 weekday and £160 weekend evenings (community), £118 and £180 (standard).
ppluk.com	SFE tariff for disco and club night music, revised 1 January 2026. No price published.

Appendix B. Figures Still to Be Verified

These are the inputs I could not confirm from a published source. Each one is a blue cell in the model, and each one should be replaced with a real quote or price before launch.

Input	In the model	How to check it
Hall hire per hour	£50 an hour, five hours	Written quotes from five halls. Ask about floors and wheels.
Public and employers liability insurance	£1,200 a year	Quotes from two specialist brokers.
Music licence	£45 a night	Quote from PPL PRS for a three and a half hour disco.
Hire grade skates	£110 a pair, with £10 of pads	Quotes for 50 pairs, new and refurbished.
Private hire price	£500 for two hours, 40 skaters	Ring three competitors as a customer.
Ticketing and card fees	6 percent	Check the current fee of the chosen platform.
Marshal pay	£15 an hour loaded	Check the National Living Wage and employer costs.
Start Up Loan	£5,500 at 6 percent over five years	Check current terms and eligibility.
Demand for adult nights in Epsom	40 to 55 skaters a night in the pilot	The pilot itself, and the Founding Skater Pass test.
Flipper's Roller Boogie Palace prices	£12.50 to £17.50, hire £5, from a listing	Check the operator's own page.
Adult only roller nights nearby	None found	Search Eventbrite, Facebook events and ask local skaters.

Disclaimer

This business plan is a practice document for a venture the author may choose to start. It is not financial, legal or insurance advice. Financial figures are modelled estimates built from stated assumptions, and several are placeholders until real quotes arrive. Competitor facts come from public sources in October 2026 and may have changed. Tax calculations are simplified. Anyone relying on this plan should check each figure and legal point against current sources and take professional advice before committing money.